

## UNIT 8 / Travel with confidence

# Catch the right train

Your goal: Read basic departure information and buy a simple ticket.

## 01 Learn the idea

At a station, look for Abfahrt for departure, Ankunft for arrival and Gleis for platform or track. The destination may appear after nach: nach Berlin. Use Ich möchte ein Ticket nach Köln to buy a ticket and ask Einfach oder hin und zurück? to distinguish one-way and return journeys.

Timetables commonly use the 24-hour clock. Der Zug fährt um fünfzehn Uhr means the train leaves at 15:00. A delay is Verspätung. Check the destination, time and platform together; finding the right city name alone is not enough if several trains leave for it.

## Words and phrases

| German         | English             |
|----------------|---------------------|
| die Abfahrt    | the departure       |
| die Ankunft    | the arrival         |
| Gleis drei     | platform three      |
| einfach        | one-way             |
| hin und zurück | return / round trip |

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

## 02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

**Ben**

Ein Ticket nach Köln, bitte.

A ticket to Cologne, please.

**Clerk**

Einfach oder hin und zurück?

One-way or return?

**Ben**

Einfach. Wann fährt der Zug?

One-way. When does the train leave?

**Clerk**

Um fünfzehn Uhr, Gleis drei.

At fifteen hundred, platform three.

### Your real-life mission

Make a fictional ticket showing destination, departure time and platform. Read all three facts aloud and ask for a one-way ticket.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

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## 03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

### 1. What does “die Abfahrt” mean?

- A. the arrival
- B. the departure
- C. platform three

### 2. What does “die Ankunft” mean?

- A. platform three
- B. one-way
- C. the arrival

### 3. What does “Gleis drei” mean?

- A. platform three
- B. one-way
- C. return / round trip

### 4. Which word identifies a departure?

- A. Ankunft
- B. Abfahrt
- C. Rückfahrt

### 5. Which platform does Ben need?

- A. Five
- B. Fifteen
- C. Three

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

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# 04 Answer key and review

## 1. B - the departure

“die Abfahrt” means “the departure”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

## 2. C - the arrival

“die Ankunft” means “the arrival”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

## 3. A - platform three

“Gleis drei” means “platform three”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

## 4. B - Abfahrt

Abfahrt is departure; Ankunft is arrival.

## 5. C - Three

The clerk says Gleis drei.

## One possible mission response

Ein Ticket nach Köln, bitte. Einfach. Der Zug fährt um fünfzehn Uhr von Gleis drei.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

## Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

## Continue learning

Open your interactive course at <https://everygyan.com/learn-german>. Free additional A1 practice: <https://www.goethe.de/prj/dfd/en/home.cfm>

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